

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mrs Selmah Tulsidas

Address: 36 Toll Bar Court Basinghall Gardens Sutton SM2 6AT

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment:Reference: DM2025/01591

(18 Dorset Road, SM2 6JH)

Date: 22 February 2026

Dear Planning Officer,

I am writing as a local resident of Sutton to express my strongest support for the proposed community centre and place of worship at the former ambulance station.

As a 69-year-old resident, I believe this application is a vital improvement for our area for the following material planning reasons:

1. Sustainable Reuse of a Vacant Site: This site was previously an active ambulance station with 24/7 sirens and heavy emergency vehicle movements. Converting it into a community centre represents a significantly lower impact on the quiet residential character of Dorset Road. It is far better to have a managed community hub than a vacant building that attracts antisocial behaviour.
2. Addressing Social Isolation (Policy 25): At my age, easy access to local community facilities is essential for my mental and physical wellbeing. This centre will provide a "lifetime neighbourhood" hub where I can meet others, avoiding the isolation that many seniors in SM2 face.
3. Minimal Traffic Impact: I have reviewed the traffic analysis and, as a local resident, I confirm

that many of us intend to access the site on foot or by local bus. Unlike the previous ambulance use, the centre's arrivals are predictable and will be managed by marshals to ensure no driveways are ever blocked.

4. Equality and Inclusion: Under the Public Sector Equality Duty, the Council has a responsibility to support facilities that serve minority groups and the elderly.

Approval of this site would demonstrate Sutton's commitment to an inclusive community.

I urge the Council to approve this application so that we can bring this building back into a use that truly serves the residents of Belmont and Sutton.

Yours faithfully,

Mrs Selmah Tulsidas